HUSH Guide

A de-noiser for your guitar or bass DI, with zero latency. VST3 plugin and standalone app, Windows 10 / 11, 64-bit.



The same Hush is built into dJONt and Parabola Bass Z (click HUSH in their header). This one is for everything else: other amp sims, or a Quad Cortex / modeller fed from your DAW.

1 · Install

1. Run **Hush-v...-windows-x64.exe**. Windows may show **"Windows protected your PC"** (an unsigned hobby build, not a store app): **More info**, then **Run anyway**.
2. Leave both parts ticked, the **VST3 plugin** and the **standalone app**, and click Install.

WHAT	WHERE IT GOES
VST3 plugin	`C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3\Hush.vst3`
Standalone app	`C:\Program Files\Hush\Hush.exe`, Start menu → Hush
This guide	Start menu → Hush → *Hush Guide*

2 · First run

1. **In a DAW:** rescan VST3 plugins (Reaper: Options → Preferences → Plug-ins → VST → **Re-scan**), then put Hush **first** on your DI track, before any amp sim, drive or compressor. Those amplify noise; Hush has to hear it before they do.
2. **Standalone:** click **Options → Audio/MIDI Settings**, pick **ASIO** and your interface, and tick your instrument's input. The app mutes its input at first to prevent feedback: untick **Mute audio input**.
3. Volume up on your instrument, **hands off the strings**, click **LEARN** and wait two seconds. Hush now knows your noise floor in each band.
4. Play, and raise **Strength** until the hiss is gone. If quiet notes lose sparkle, lower **Sensitivity** or **Strength**.

> Hush starts **on** in its own plugin. Inside dJONt and Parabola it's **off** until you turn it on, so your old presets sound the same.

3 · How it works

Hush watches eight bands from 200 Hz up (200, 350, 600 Hz, 1, 1.8, 3.2, 5.6 kHz and everything over 9 kHz). Each band has its own noise floor, set by LEARN. The moment your note shows up in a band it opens, within about two milliseconds, so pick attacks get through. A band with only noise in it is turned down with an EQ cut, by up to 30 dB at full Strength.

So it cleans up **between notes** like a gate, but also **under notes**: a low chug fills the bottom bands and leaves the top ones to hiss, and Hush turns just those down. Nothing is delayed (no look-ahead), and with every band open your signal is untouched.

Below 200 Hz nothing changes: hum is a job for a gate, and on a Jazz Bass, for both pickup volumes full up (that's when the pickups cancel each other's hum).

4 · Controls

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
ON / OFF	Off is a perfect bypass, bit for bit.
LEARN	Two seconds of listening, hands off the strings, to set each band's noise floor. Saved with your session or preset.
Strength	How far a noise-only band is turned down (100% = 30 dB). Default 60%.
Sensitivity	How far over its floor a band has to be to count as your note, 0 to 24 dB. Higher cleans more but can dull quiet notes. Default 6 dB.
Release	How fast a band turns down once your note leaves it, 10 to 500 ms. Short is tighter, long is smoother. Default 120 ms.
Band meters	How far each band is being turned down right now.
IN / OUT	Peak level into and out of Hush.

5 · Tips

IF	TRY THIS
Hiss comes back after a while	LEARN again. Re-learn whenever you change guitar, pickup, cable or interface gain.
Quiet notes or harmonics sound duller	Lower Sensitivity first, then Strength.
Tails sound choppy	Raise Release (200 ms or more).
Still a buzz between notes	That's probably hum below 200 Hz: add a gate after Hush. With Hush on you can set the gate lower, so notes fade out more naturally.
Using a Quad Cortex	Put Hush on the DI track in your DAW and send its output to the QC, or record the DI through Hush.
Uninstall	Windows Settings → Apps → Hush → Uninstall.

Hover any control in Hush for a tip in the bar at the bottom. Double-click a knob to reset it. Drag the bottom-right corner to resize (60% to 200%).